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ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT CELL (RDC)

Annual Activity Report – Academic Year 2024–2025

1. Introduction

The Research & Development Cell (RDC) of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur functions as a platform to promote and strengthen a culture of research, innovation, creativity, academic collaboration, and knowledge creation among faculty members and students. The Cell works in coordination with the IQAC and academic departments to encourage research-oriented teaching, faculty development, interdisciplinary activities, and dissemination of research outcomes.

During the academic year 2024–2025, the RDC undertook various initiatives to create awareness about research opportunities, encourage faculty and students to participate in research activities, and strengthen the institutional research ecosystem.

2. Objectives of the RDC

The major objectives of the Research & Development Cell are:

- To promote a research culture among faculty and students.
- To encourage faculty members to undertake research projects and publish research papers.
- To create awareness about funding opportunities, research grants and fellowships.
- To encourage participation in seminars, conferences, workshops and faculty development programmes.
- To promote innovation, interdisciplinary research and problem-solving approaches.
- To facilitate collaboration with academic institutions, industries and research organisations.
- To create awareness about Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), patents and copyrights.

- To encourage students to develop research aptitude, scientific temper and innovative thinking.
- To support the documentation and dissemination of institutional research activities.

3. Major Activities During 2024–2025

3.1 Promotion of Research Culture

The RDC encouraged faculty members and students to actively engage in research-oriented academic activities. Departments were motivated to identify contemporary research areas and integrate research-based learning into classroom teaching.

3.2 Research Awareness and Capacity Building

Awareness was created among faculty members regarding:

- Research methodology and academic writing
- Identification of research problems
- Publication of research papers
- Research ethics and academic integrity
- Funding opportunities and research proposals
- Conferences, seminars and workshops
- Intellectual Property Rights and patents

Faculty members were encouraged to participate in professional development and research-oriented programmes organised by reputed academic institutions and organisations.

3.3 Faculty Research and Publications

Faculty members were encouraged to undertake independent and collaborative research in their respective disciplines. The RDC supported faculty participation in:

- Research paper presentations
- National and international conferences
- Seminars and workshops
- Faculty Development Programmes
- Research-oriented training programmes

- Publication activities

The Cell also encouraged faculty members to maintain proper records of their publications, presentations, participation and other research contributions.

3.4 Student Research and Innovation

The RDC promoted research aptitude and innovative thinking among students through academic projects, presentations, laboratory activities, seminars and department-level activities.

Students were encouraged to:

- Identify real-life problems
- Develop innovative ideas
- Undertake project-based learning
- Participate in seminars and academic competitions
- Explore interdisciplinary approaches
- Present their ideas and research findings

3.5 Research Methodology and Academic Writing

Departments encouraged students and faculty members to develop skills in research methodology, literature review, data collection, analysis, interpretation and academic writing. Emphasis was placed on maintaining academic standards and research integrity.

3.6 Intellectual Property Rights Awareness

The institution promoted awareness regarding Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), including patents, copyrights, trademarks and protection of innovative ideas. Faculty and students were encouraged to understand the importance of protecting and documenting their original intellectual contributions.

3.7 Research Infrastructure and Resources

The institution continued to strengthen the research environment through the effective utilisation of:

- Departmental laboratories
- Library resources
- Digital learning resources

- DELNET resources
- ICT facilities
- Internet and computational facilities
- Departmental academic resources

Faculty and students were encouraged to make effective use of available resources for academic and research purposes.

3.8 Interdisciplinary and Collaborative Initiatives

The RDC encouraged departments to explore interdisciplinary research and academic collaboration. Faculty members were motivated to interact with researchers, academic institutions and professional organisations for knowledge sharing and collaborative opportunities.

3.9 Participation in Research and Academic Events

Faculty members and students were encouraged to participate in relevant seminars, conferences, workshops, FDPs, webinars and academic events conducted by universities, colleges, research institutions and professional bodies.

3.10 Documentation and Monitoring

The RDC maintained and encouraged systematic documentation of research activities, including:

- Faculty publications
- Research presentations
- Participation certificates
- Research projects
- Seminars and workshops
- Student projects
- IPR-related activities
- Research collaborations
- Other research achievements

The Cell also coordinated with the **IQAC** for documentation and quality enhancement initiatives.

4. Key Outcomes

The activities of the RDC during 2024–2025 contributed to:

- Strengthening the **research culture** of the institution.
- Creating greater awareness about research opportunities.
- Encouraging faculty participation in research and academic programmes.
- Developing research aptitude among students.
- Promoting innovation and interdisciplinary thinking.
- Increasing awareness of IPR and academic research ethics.
- Encouraging the utilisation of library, laboratory and digital research resources.
- Strengthening documentation of research and innovation activities.
- Supporting the institution's continuous quality improvement initiatives.

5. Future Plan

The RDC proposes to further strengthen research and innovation activities by:

1. Organising Research Methodology Workshops for faculty and students.
2. Conducting awareness programmes on Research Funding and Project Proposals.
3. Promoting quality research publications.
4. Encouraging faculty members to apply for funded research projects.
5. Conducting IPR and Patent Awareness Programmes.
6. Promoting student research projects and innovative ideas.
7. Developing interdisciplinary research initiatives.
8. Strengthening academic and industry collaborations.
9. Encouraging research-based seminars and conferences.
10. Establishing systematic mechanisms for documenting and monitoring research outcomes.

6. Conclusion

The Research & Development Cell of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur continued its efforts during the academic year 2024–2025 to nurture a positive and sustainable research environment. Through awareness, capacity building, academic participation, innovation-oriented activities and effective utilization of institutional resources, the RDC contributed to strengthening the institution's commitment to research, innovation, academic excellence and societal development.

The Cell remains committed to promoting a vibrant research ecosystem and encouraging faculty and students to contribute meaningfully to knowledge creation and the development of innovative solutions for society.

Research & Development Cell (RDC)
St. Ann's College for Women
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